

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

checklist

Items with state markers — done, partial, todo.

The checklist tracks readiness in four states.

☒ Done rows take a solid check

☒ Keep each line under ten words

☐ Half-done rows show the dash

☐ Open rows stay empty boxes

☐ Descoped rows get the slash

☐ Eight rows is the soft ceiling

Nine rows is where the checklist overflows.

- ✓ The first rows land while attention is fresh
- ✓ Sixteen words is the budget a stress row may spend
- ✓ Three checks in a row read as momentum
- A dash admits the honest middle state
- Two dashes together flag where the risk lives
- Open boxes pull the eye forward
- Late rows stay short; the audience is counting now
- ~~✓ The slash records what was cut, visibly~~
- ✓ Nine is the last row this layout seats

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When NOT to reach for checklist.

All-done lists. If every item is the state markers `[x]` are decoration. `[list]` (or its `[takeaway]` variant) for celebratory recaps; checklist earns its weight when the mix matters.

Long per-item prose. Each item is one short line. If a row needs a sentence of explanation, the right home is cards-stack or list-tabular.

Custom state markers. Only `[x]`, `[-]`, `[ ]`, and `[/]` (out-of-scope, struck through) map to the mark palette. Authoring `[?]` or `[!]` renders as literal text and breaks the visual contract.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`list` — items have no state — just bullets

`list-tabular` — rows need a label-plus-description structure, not state

`cards-stack` — each item needs two sentences of body